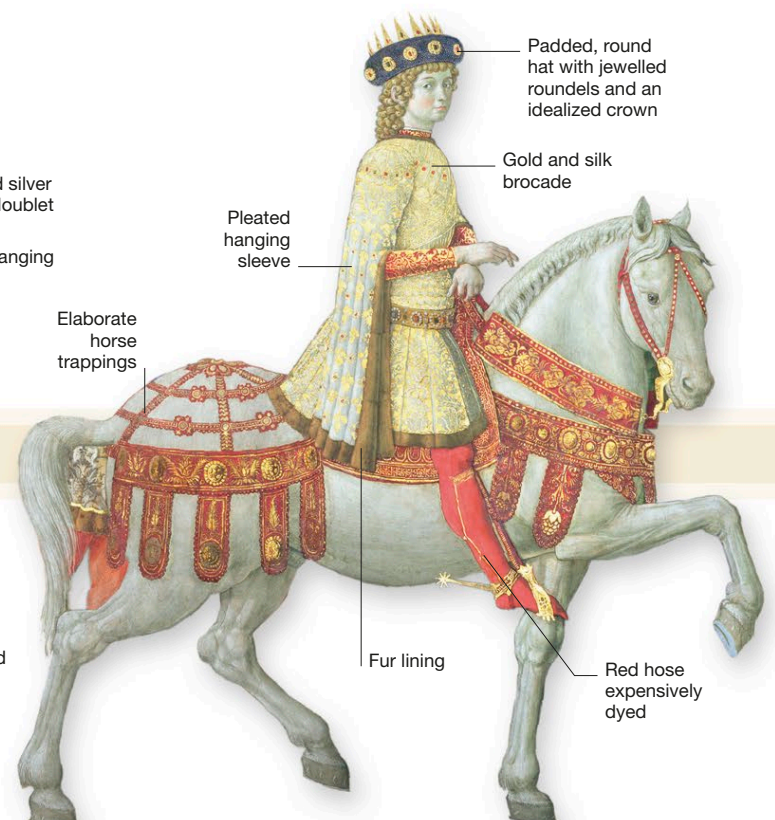




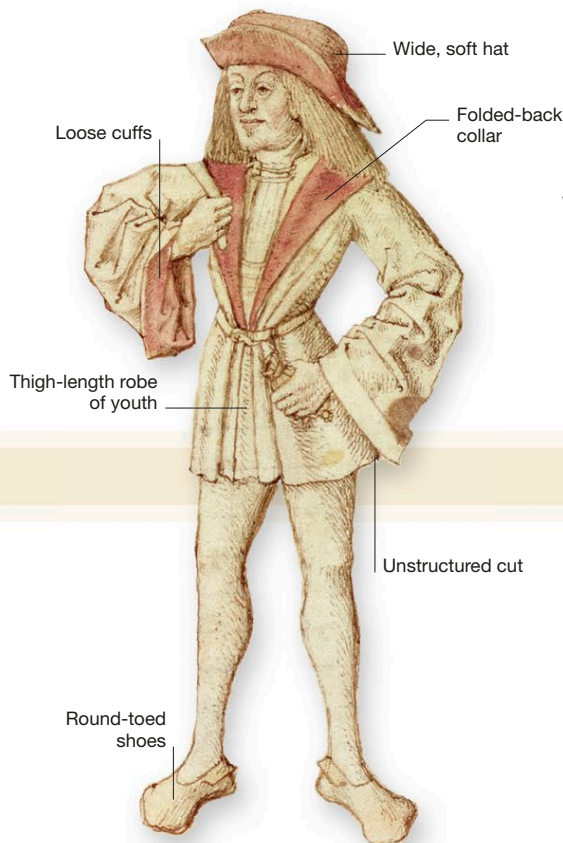
Black velvet robe Charles the Bold's outfit picked up on the popularity of black through the century. Rich, true blacks were difficult to dye and displayed a subtle expensive quality. His large *chaperon* (hat) was stuffed for shape.



Knee-length robe Sumptuary laws in many cities regulated what people in each social level could wear. This noble Florentine man used his outer gown's open sleeves to flaunt the costly Italian velvet underneath.



The power of gold Lorenzo de' Medici, the Magnificent, reflected the power of his Florentine banking family c.1460 in clothing woven with gold. Even his riding accessories were elaborately wrought and made from gold to reveal his social position.



New naturalism English clothing also became less structured and more naturalistic. This man, with his youthful clothing and cheerful expression, embodies the sanguine, optimistic character described in medieval science and medicine.



Royal simplicity By contrast with displays of wealth and excess, a ruler such as Juan II of Portugal chose to dress simply and elegantly. The red silk velvet of his doublet is a valuable textile despite its restrained use.

LIFE CHANGES



As a man moved through each stage of life, his clothing changed to reveal his place in society. Active young men wore short, fitted doublets and robes revealing shapely thighs. In adult maturity, around 25, the hemline started creeping further down the thigh. By middle and old age hemlines reached the floor. Longer and darker robes enhanced dignity for professional and political men, and for those who did not do manual labour, such as scholars and doctors. The floor-length robes also kept them warm.